



**moral
realism**



**moral
nihilism**



**moral
relativism**

The simplest view that the moral nihilism might take is that we are simply making a mistake: we are making claims about something which does not in fact exist.

This strikes many people as a hard view to swallow. For one thing, if moral sentences are simply all false in the way that all simple sentences about Santa are false, it seems that, once we realize this, we should simply stop using moral language. We should stop ever saying that anyone should do anything. But could this be right?

One way to make this worry sharper is to note that the error theorist will have trouble saying that one of the following sentences is in any sense better than the other:

‘‘Enslaving people is
morally wrong.’’

“Enslaving people is
morally good.”

According to the error theorist, nothing is wrong or good — so these sentences are,
equally, mistakes.

The simplest view that the moral nihilist might take is that we

are simply making mistakes: we are making claims about

something which does not in fact exist.

are simply false in the way that all simple sentences about Santa are false, it

seeing that, once we realize this, we should simply stop using machine language. We

This strikes many people as a hard view to swallow. For one thing, if moral sentences

should stop saying that anyone should do anything. But could this be right?

One way to make this worry sharper is to note that the error theorist will have

other:

troubled saying that none of the following sentences is in any sense better than the



‘‘Einsparungspoleis

morally wrong.



noiraily good.;

‘Einsaving people is

According to the error theorist, nothing is wrong or good — these sentences are,

equally, mistakes.